Argustack Quick Start Guide

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Get from zero to your first AI-powered project query in under 5 minutes.

Visit the project on GitHub or install from npm.

> **Note:** This documentation is actively maintained alongside the codebase. While we verify accuracy with each release, minor discrepancies may exist as features evolve. For the latest information, refer to the GitHub repository. Found an issue? Open a ticket.

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1. Prerequisites

Before you start, make sure you have:

Requirement	Version	Check
Node.js	20+	`node --version`
Docker	Any recent	`docker --version`
Claude Desktop or **Claude Code**	Latest	Installed and running

You'll also need credentials for at least one data source:

Source	What you need
Jira Cloud	URL, email, API token
Jira CSV	Exported CSV file (no credentials needed)
Git	Path to local repo on disk
GitHub	Personal access token (fine-grained, read-only)
Database	Host, port, user, password, database name (read-only access)

2. Install

```
npm install -g argustack
```

Verify installation:

```
argustack --version
```

3. Initialize a Workspace

Navigate to your project directory and run:

```
argustack init
```

The interactive wizard will:

1. **Ask for a workspace name** — creates a named subdirectory (e.g. `my-project/`)
2. **Create workspace files** — `.argustack/`, `.env`, `docker-compose.yml`, `.mcp.json`
3. **Ask which sources to enable** — Jira, Git, GitHub, CSV, Database
4. **Collect credentials** — API tokens, repo paths, project keys (Jira URL and email are masked with asterisks during input)
5. **Auto-configure Claude Code** — writes `.mcp.json` in workspace + parent directory, and updates global `~/.claude/settings.json`
6. **Start PostgreSQL** — Docker container on port 5434

Non-Interactive Mode

For CI/CD or scripted setups:

```
argustack init --no-interactive \
  --jira-url https://your-instance.atlassian.net \
  --jira-email you@company.com \
  --jira-token xxxxxxxxxxx \
  --jira-projects PROJ,TEAM \
  --git-repo /path/to/repo \
  --github-token ghp_xxxx \
  --github-owner your-org \
  --github-repo your-repo
```

CSV-Only Setup

If you don't have Jira API access, export issues as CSV from Jira and use:

```
argustack init
# Select "csv" as source type
# Point to your exported CSV file
```

4. Sync Your Data

Pull all enabled sources:

```
argustack sync
```

Or sync specific sources:

```
argustack sync jira           # Jira issues, comments, changelogs
argustack sync git            # Git commits and file changes
argustack sync github         # PRs, reviews, releases
argustack sync csv            # Import from CSV file
argustack sync db             # Pull external database schema
```

What happens during sync

```
Source API  →  Argustack  →  Local PostgreSQL
(Jira/Git/GitHub)              (Docker, port 5434)
```

- Data streams in batches (100 issues per page)
- Progress bar shows completion: `150/506 issues (30%)`
- Re-running sync is safe — UPSERT, no duplicates
- Incremental by default — only pulls new/updated data

Incremental Sync

```
argustack sync --since 2025-01-01    # Only changes after this date
argustack sync jira -p PROJ          # Specific project
```

5. Connect Claude

Claude Code

No extra steps needed. `argustack init` automatically writes `.mcp.json` in the workspace and parent directories, and updates global `~/.claude/settings.json`. Just open the workspace folder in Claude Code — MCP tools are ready.

Claude Desktop

```
argustack mcp install
```

This adds the MCP configuration to `claude_desktop_config.json`. Restart Claude Desktop to activate.

Verify connection

In Claude, ask:

> "Use workspace_info to show my Argustack setup"

You should see your workspace path, configured sources, and database connection.

6. Your First Queries

Once connected, try these queries with Claude:

Search issues

> "Search for issues related to payment processing"

Claude uses `query_issues` to full-text search your Jira issues.

Check a specific ticket

> "Show me full details of PROJ-123"

Claude uses `get_issue` to return description, comments, changelogs, and all custom fields.

Cross-reference code and tickets

> "What code was written for PROJ-123?"

Claude uses `issue_commits` to find all Git commits mentioning this issue key.

Full timeline

> "Show me the complete timeline for PROJ-123 — from ticket creation to code merge"

Claude uses `issue_timeline` to combine Jira changelogs, Git commits, and GitHub PRs into one chronological view.

Project overview

> "Give me a breakdown of all issues by status and assignee"

Claude uses `issue_stats` for aggregate statistics.

Estimate a task

> "How long will it take John to fix a login timeout bug?"

Claude uses `estimate` to predict duration based on similar completed tasks and John's personal velocity.

7. Next Steps

Enable hybrid search

Generate AI embeddings to upgrade hybrid search from text-only to text + semantic:

```
argustack embed
```

Requires `OPENAI_API_KEY` in `.env`. After embedding, ask Claude:

> "Find issues similar to 'users can't reset their password'"

Explore all 20 MCP tools

Category	Tools
Jira	query_issues, get_issue, issue_stats, pull_jira, list_projects
Git	query_commits, issue_commits, commit_stats
GitHub	query_prs, issue_prs, query_releases
Database	db_schema, db_query, db_stats
Cross-source	issue_timeline, hybrid_search, estimate
System	workspace_info, switch_workspace, list_workspaces

Browse your data directly

pgweb UI is available at `http://localhost:8086` — browse tables, run SQL queries, explore your data visually.

Multiple workspaces

Each project gets its own named workspace. Running `argustack init` again in the same directory creates a new workspace as a subdirectory. Use `switch_workspace` and `list_workspaces` MCP tools to navigate between them from within Claude.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Docker not running	`docker compose up -d` in workspace directory
Port conflict on 5434	Edit `DB_PORT` in `.env` and `docker-compose.yml`
Module not found	Check Node.js 20+ and reinstall: `npm i -g argustack`
MCP not connecting	Run `argustack mcp install` and restart Claude
Sync shows 0 issues	Verify credentials in `.env`, check project keys

Visit the project on **GitHub** or install from **npm**.